

Courting grass: On Wimbledon 2025

Sinner and Alcaraz look **set to establish** a famed rivalry

Feats on grass have a special **allure**. When they come at Wimbledon, the most **prestigious** grass court on the planet, they acquire a richer **tone** of **lustre**. **Jannik Sinner and Iga Swiatek**, who won their **maiden** titles at the All England Club over the weekend, **stand testament to** this. Both were past **Major** champions, with Sinner having won three and Swiatek five trophies. Yet, **by their own admission**, very few achievements **rank alongside** their **runs** on the **pristine lawns** of southwest London. The wins also come at a critical **juncture** in their tennis lives as both players **served** doping-related bans in recent months and had their sporting **ethics questioned**. For Sinner, the **success** against two-time **defending** and five-time Slam champion Carlos Alcaraz **snapped** a **streak** of five **straight** losses to the **Spaniard**. This sequence contained the most painful of all defeats, at **Roland-Garros** last month where **the Italian** lost despite being three championship points up. The victory at SW19 showed the 23-year-old's **remarkable** powers of recovery and mental **resilience**. For Swiatek, Wimbledon was her first trophy of any kind since the French Open 2024. **The Pole**, who had spent a combined 125 weeks as No. 1 — seventh best in history — **had slid down** the rankings and **had** lost her **aura**. But by winning on her **least-favoured** surface, she has **resurrected** her career **emphatically**.

Sinner's and Swiatek's **triumphs** will also have **wide-ranging** effects on their respective Tours. Sinner and Alcaraz have now split the last seven Majors between them, and Wimbledon was the second straight Slam final they were **sparring in**. In fact, starting from the Rome Masters in early May where Sinner made his comeback from **doping suspension**, they have **clashed** in the final in all three competitions they have both been part of, **reinforcing** the view that **theirs** is now men's tennis' **pre-eminent** rivalry. They have met 13 times — 10 of them in semifinal or better — and appear to have fully **satiated** fans' desire to see a worthy **follow-up** to the **famed** Roger Federer-Rafael Nadal **duel**. Ranked No. 1 and No. 2, they are also **head and shoulders above** the rest of the field. The **gulf** is best explained by Sinner's ATP points-tally of 12,030, which is nearly double that of third-ranked Alexander Zverev. **Swiatek**, meanwhile, **has** re-established the **triumvirate atop** the women's game. The 24-year-old may be the ninth different Wimbledon winner in as many editions, but she, Aryna Sabalenka and Coco Gauff have won 10 of the past 14 Majors. Swiatek's six Slams make her **the leading light** among active women, a position she seems **primed to hold on to**. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

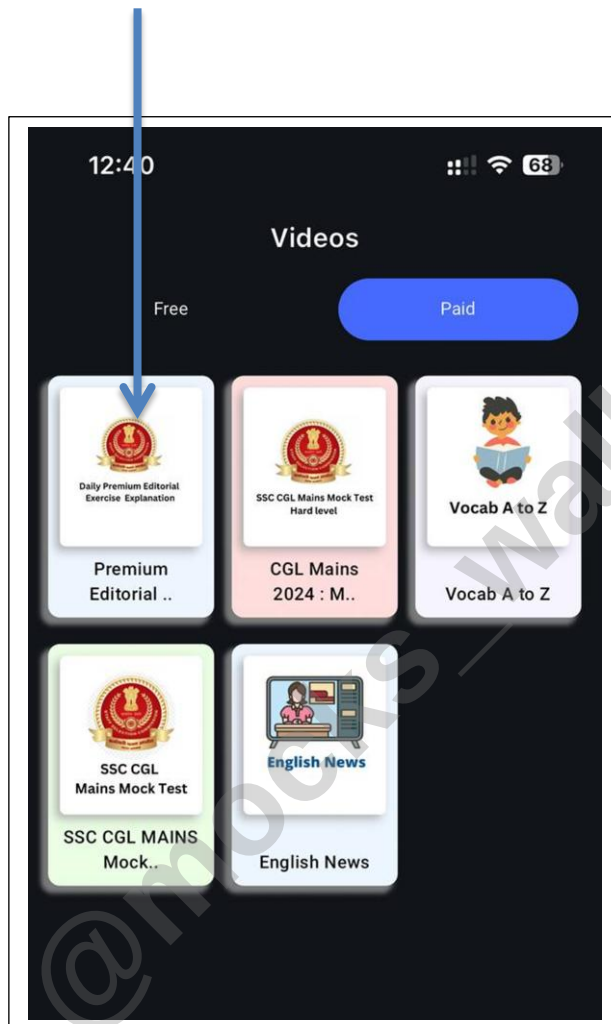
Vocabulary

1. **Set to** (phrasal verb) – ready, prepared, poised, scheduled, determined – तैयार
2. **Establish** (verb) – found, set up, create, institute, build – स्थापित करना
3. **Famed** (adjective) – renowned, celebrated, illustrious, distinguished, noted – प्रसिद्ध
4. **Rivalry** (noun) – competition, contest, duel, opposition, conflict – प्रतिद्वंद्विता
5. **Feat** (noun) – achievement, accomplishment, exploit, triumph, act – उपलब्धि
6. **Allure** (noun) – attraction, charm, appeal, fascination, magnetism – आकर्षण
7. **Prestigious** (adjective) – esteemed, reputable, respected, eminent, renowned – प्रतिष्ठित
8. **Tone** (noun) – quality, character, mood, atmosphere, nuance – स्वर / लहजा
9. **Lustre** (noun) – shine, brilliance, glow, radiance, gloss – चमक
10. **Maiden** (adjective) – first, inaugural, initial, debut, original – पहला / प्रारंभिक
11. **Stand testament to** (phrase) – prove, demonstrate, bear witness, validate, confirm – प्रमाण होना
12. **Major** (noun) – It refers to one of the four Grand Slam tournaments: the Australian Open, the French Open (Roland Garros), Wimbledon, and the US Open.
13. **By one's own admission** (phrase) – as acknowledged, as confessed, self-declared, stated, revealed – स्वयं के स्वीकार अनुसार
14. **Rank** (verb) – rate, classify, position, place, categorize – स्थान देना / दर्जा देना
15. **Alongside** (adverb) – beside, next to, together with, parallel to, with – के साथ-साथ
16. **Run** (noun) – streak, spell, sequence, stretch, series – दौर
17. **Pristine** (adjective) – pure, unspoiled, immaculate, clean, flawless – स्वच्छ / निर्मल
18. **Lawn** (noun) – grass, turf, green, meadow, sward – लॉन / घास का मैदान
19. **Juncture** (noun) – point, moment, stage, phase, time – मोड़ / चरण
20. **Serve** (verb) – complete, undergo, discharge, fulfill, carry out – पूरा करना / सेवा देना
21. **Ethics** (noun) – morality, principles, values, integrity, code – नैतिकता

22. **Question** (verb) – doubt, challenge, dispute, interrogate, examine – सवाल उठाना / पूछना
23. **Defending champion** (noun) – someone who has won a competition and is now participating again, aiming to retain their title वर्तमान विजेता
24. **Snap** (verb) – break, end, halt, interrupt, terminate – समाप्त करना / तोड़ना
25. **Streak** (noun) – series, run, spell, sequence, chain – लगातार सिलसिला
26. **Straight** (adjective) – consecutive, successive, continuous, uninterrupted, direct – लगातार
27. **The Spaniard** (noun) – Here it refers to 'Carlos Alcaraz'.
28. **Roland-Garros** (noun) – one of the four Grand Slam tennis tournaments and is the premier clay court tennis championship. रोलां गैर्रो (फ्रेंच ओपन)
29. **The Italian** (noun) – Here it refers to 'Jannik Sinner'.
30. **Remarkable** (adjective) – extraordinary, notable, exceptional, outstanding, impressive – असाधारण
31. **Resilience** (noun) – toughness, endurance, strength, recovery, adaptability मज़बूती
32. **The Pole** (noun) – Here it refers to 'Iga Swiatek'.
33. **Slide down** (phrasal verb) – fall, drop, decline, descend, deteriorate – गिरना
34. **Aura** (noun) – presence, charisma, vibe, atmosphere, impression – आभा
35. **Least-favoured** (adjective) – weakest, lowest-rated, unfavorable, disliked, unsuitable – सबसे कम पसंदीदा
36. **Resurrect** (verb) – revive, restore, renew, reinstate, regenerate – पुनर्जीवित करना
37. **Emphatically** (adverb) – forcefully, clearly, decidedly, strongly, assertively – जोरदार ढंग से
38. **Triumph** (noun) – victory, success, win, achievement, conquest – विजय
39. **Wide-ranging** (adjective) – extensive, broad, sweeping, comprehensive, inclusive – व्यापक
40. **Spar in** (phrasal verb) – compete, clash, duel, contend, fight – मुकाबला करना
41. **Doping** (noun) – the unlawful use of drugs to enhance or inhibit the performance of an athlete, racehorse, or greyhound.
42. **Suspension** (noun) – ban, disqualification, removal, prohibition, exclusion – निलंबन
43. **Clash** (verb) – fight, compete, collide, encounter, confront – भिड़ना
44. **Reinforce** (verb) – strengthen, support, bolster, back, validate – सुदृढ़ करना

45. **Theirs** (noun) – their rivalry, relationship, competition, belonging – उनका (संबंध/प्रतिस्पर्धा)
46. **Pre-eminent** (adjective) – leading, foremost, topmost, supreme, distinguished – सर्वोच्च
47. **Satiated** (adjective) – fulfilled, satisfied, gratified, contented, replete – संतुष्ट
48. **Follow-up** (noun) – continuation, sequel, aftereffect, outcome, response – अनुसरण / अगली कड़ी
49. **Duel** (noun) – battle, contest, fight, match, competition – द्वंद्व
50. **Head and shoulders above** (phrase) – far superior, clearly better, unmatched, outstanding, excellent – कहीं बेहतर
51. **Gulf** (noun) – gap, difference, divide, disparity, separation – अंतर
52. **Meanwhile** (adverb) – in the meantime, simultaneously, at the same time, currently, concurrently – इसी बीच
53. **The Triumvirate** (noun) – trio, threesome, trinity, triplet, group of three – त्रय / तीन का समूह
54. **Atop** (preposition) – on top of, above, over, upon, uppermost – के ऊपर
55. **The leading light** (phrase) – a person who is prominent or influential in a particular field or organization. – प्रमुख व्यक्ति
56. **Primed** (adjective) – ready, prepared, equipped, set, geared – तैयार
57. **Hold on to** (phrase) – retain, keep, maintain, preserve, cling to – बनाए रखना

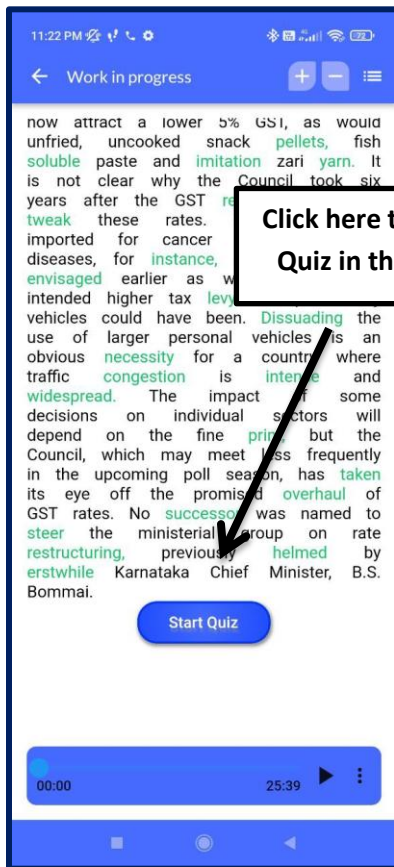
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



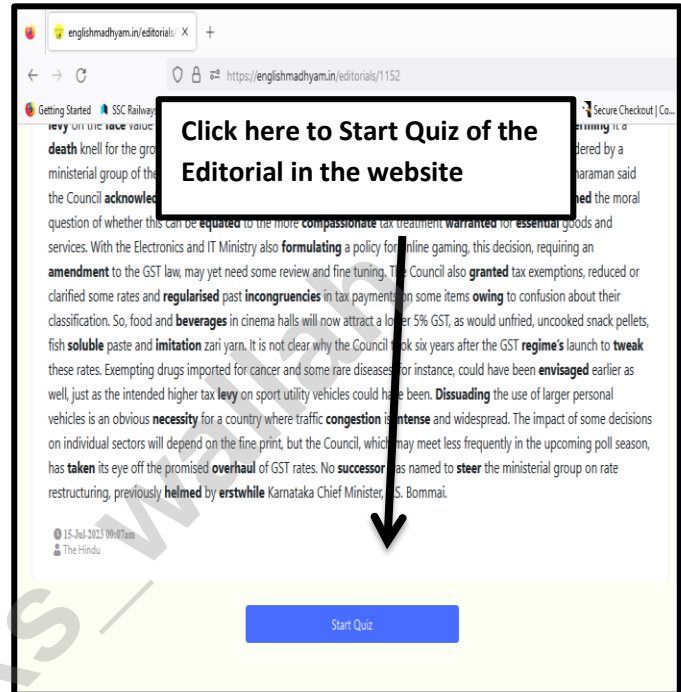
Summary of the Editorial

1. Wimbledon 2025 saw Jannik Sinner and Iga Swiatek claim their first titles at the prestigious All England Club.
2. Both Sinner and Swiatek were previous Grand Slam champions, but considered this Wimbledon victory among their most cherished.
3. Their wins were particularly significant as both had returned from doping-related suspensions, casting doubts on their sporting ethics earlier.
4. Sinner defeated Carlos Alcaraz, a two-time defending champion and five-time Slam winner, ending a five-match losing streak against him.
5. The victory was a mental and emotional comeback for Sinner, especially after losing from championship point at Roland-Garros 2025.
6. For Swiatek, it marked her first title since French Open 2024, helping her regain confidence after slipping down the rankings.
7. Winning on grass, her weakest surface, signified a career resurgence for Swiatek.
8. Sinner and Alcaraz have now split the last seven Grand Slams, confirming their status as modern tennis rivals.
9. Since Sinner's comeback at the Rome Masters (May 2025), he and Alcaraz have met in the final of all three tournaments they've contested together.
10. Their 13-match rivalry, including 10 semifinal-or-higher clashes, echoes the Federer–Nadal era in excitement and prestige.
11. Ranked No. 1 and 2, Sinner and Alcaraz are far ahead of the rest, with Sinner's ATP points nearly double that of No. 3 Zverev.
12. On the women's side, Swiatek has now re-established dominance, forming a top trio with Sabalenka and Coco Gauff.
13. Although Swiatek is the ninth different Wimbledon winner in nine years, she is part of the group that won 10 of the last 14 Majors.
14. With six Grand Slams, Swiatek is now the most successful active woman player.
15. Their 2025 Wimbledon victories not only mark personal redemption but also reshape the landscape of modern tennis.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



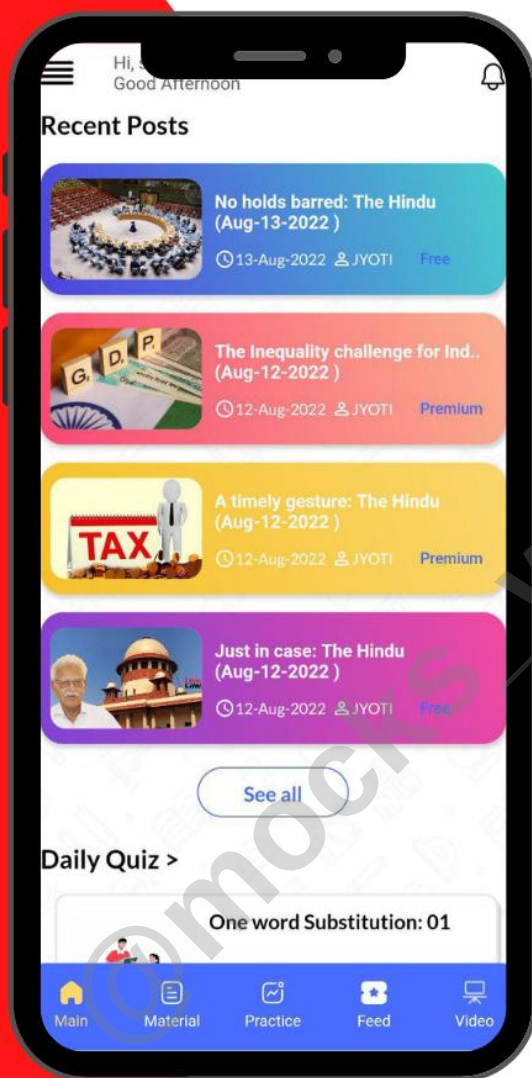
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